Guitar Exercises - Section XII, Level 90

Jazz Swing, Shuffle, Afrobeat/Latin Interlock, Jam-Band Pocket, and Multi-Style Groove Synthesis

Level 90 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. This completes Section XII. HARD STOP after Level 105.

This level does not try to reduce entire musical traditions to one guitar pattern. It trains transferable groove mechanics: subdivision feel, repeated figures, interlock, space, comping placement, register, and section-aware orchestration.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Jazz swing subdivision and comping placement	144
B	Shuffle hierarchy and triplet-feel control	144
C	Afrobeat-style interlocking upper-voice patterns	144
D	Latin-influenced clave-aware chord placement	144
E	Jam-band pocket, space, and motif cycling	144
F	Style-preserving reharmonization	128
G	Rapid style-switch and tempo-identity drills	128
H	Four eight-bar synthesis studies	192
I	Forty-bar Section XII groove capstone	320
J	Section XII mastery and recovery audit	64
	TOTAL	1552

Core rule: a style change must be audible before the chord vocabulary changes.

Reference - Five Groove Engines

Engine	Subdivision	Primary guitar behavior	Avoid
Jazz swing	triplet-based eighth feel	short comping chords, delayed/anticipated placements	straight eighths unless intended
Shuffle	long-short triplet pair	riff/chord pulse with strong internal bounce	flattening into even eighths
Afrobeat-style interlock	steady 16ths / repeated cells	high-register repeated pattern around bass/drums	overfilling low register
Latin-influenced interlock	clave-aware placement	syncopated chord cells, rests, repeated attacks	random syncopation
Jam-band pocket	straight/shuffle hybrid as chosen	space, motif repetition, section-responsive density	constant noodling

Practice each engine first on muted strings, then one chord, then a progression.

Module A - Jazz Swing Subdivision

Count each beat as a triplet: 1-trip-let. Swing eighths use the first and third triplet positions.

Cell	Count	Contacts
1	1 trip let 2 trip let...	P - P | P - P
2	1 trip let 2 trip let...	P - x | P - x
3	1 trip let 2 trip let...	- - P | P - -
4	1 trip let 2 trip let...	P - - | - - P
5	two-beat cell	P - P | - - P
6	two-beat cell	- - P | P - x

Use one upper-register shell. The feel must remain triplet-based even when only one or two attacks occur in a bar.

Module A - Jazz Comping Placement

Study	Harmony	Placement
1	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7	beats 2 and 4
2	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7	& of 2 and & of 4 swing placement
3	Am7-D7-Gmaj7	beat 1, &2, beat 4
4	Em7-A7-Dmaj7	late beat-4 anticipation into next chord
5	Bm7b5-E7-Am7	beat 2 only, then answer
6	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	one repeated two-beat comp figure

Do not strum on every beat. The exercise is to place chords deliberately inside a swinging pulse.

Module B - Shuffle Hierarchy

The shuffle uses the same long-short triplet spacing as swing, but often with more repetitive riff or chord motion.

Cell	Pattern	Goal
1	P - P | P - P	basic shuffle pair
2	M - O | M - O	muted/open contrast
3	P - x | P - x	chord + mute
4	P - P | - - P	late answer
5	>P - P | P - >P	moving accent
6	P - P | P P P	shuffle into triplet fill

Apply to A7-D7-E7 blues, E5-A5 rock shuffle, and G-C-D country shuffle. The harmonic language changes; the shuffle spacing does not.

Module B - Swing/Shuffle Contrast

Pass	Same progression	Instruction
1	A7-D7-E7-A7	jazz swing: sparse upper shells
2	A7-D7-E7-A7	blues shuffle: repeated riff/chord pulse
3	A7-D7-E7-A7	country shuffle: alternating bass + chord
4	A7-D7-E7-A7	rock shuffle: muted low-string drive
5	A7-D7-E7-A7	return to jazz swing without changing tempo

The triplet grid stays fixed. Register, density, note length, and orchestration create the contrast.

Module C - Afrobeat-Style Interlocking Patterns

Use bright, compact triads or dyads in the middle/upper register. Keep the low register open for bass and percussion.

Cell	16th slots	Pattern idea
1	1 e & a 2 e & a	P - P - | - P - P
2	1 e & a 2 e & a	- P - P | P - - P
3	1 e & a 2 e & a	P - - P | - P P -
4	1 e & a 2 e & a	- - P - | P - P -
5	1 e & a 2 e & a	P - P - | P - - -
6	1 e & a 2 e & a	- P - - | P - P -

Repeat each two-beat cell for at least eight bars before variation. The repeated pattern must become part of the ensemble texture.

Module C - Interlock with Bass and Percussion

Bass/percussion event	Guitar response
Bass root on beat 1	guitar enters after beat 1
Bass syncopation on &2	guitar rests or sustains through &2
Percussion accent on 4	guitar may answer on a4/&1
Bass fill over beat 4	guitar ends cell early
Pedal bass	guitar changes inversion, not root register
Percussion break	guitar keeps repeated cell or drops out completely

Interlock means complementary placement, not maximum independence. If every instrument attacks together, the texture loses its weave.

Module D - Latin-Influenced Clave-Aware Placement

Use these as generic clave-awareness studies. The goal is to respect a repeating asymmetrical timeline, not to claim one universal Latin guitar pattern.

Cell	Two-bar accent map	Guitar task
A	3-side then 2-side	place short triads only on timeline landmarks
B	2-side then 3-side	reverse the two-bar emphasis
C	same timeline	one held chord across a silent landmark
D	same timeline	bass note on one landmark, chord on next
E	same timeline	repeat one syncopated cell for four bars
F	same timeline	leave one full landmark silent

Speak or clap the timeline before playing. Do not invent attacks between landmarks until the two-bar structure is secure.

Module D - Chord Interlock Studies

Progression	Upper guitar	Bass-space rule
Am7-D9	short triads	bass owns beat 1
Dm7-G7	shells + rests	no guitar during bass pickup
Cmaj7-Fmaj7	upper dyads	sustain over selected downbeat
Em7-A7	repeated syncopated cell	same cell through chord change
Gm7-C7	high-register partials	leave low strings silent
Bm7b5-E7	guide-tone dyads	land dominant third cleanly

The repeated rhythmic cell should survive chord changes; only the pitches move.

Module E - Jam-Band Pocket and Space

The exercise is to maintain a groove while leaving enough space for ensemble conversation.

Cell	Four-bar rule	Purpose
1	one chord hit + one 3-note answer per bar	basic conversation
2	repeat one motif for 4 bars	motif memory
3	bar 1-2 sparse, bar 3-4 denser	controlled build
4	bar 4 fully silent	ensemble space
5	answer only after imaginary vocal/drum cue	reactive placement
6	same motif, new register each 2 bars	development without new material

Use A-D-E-A, C-F-G-C, and Dm7-G7-Cmaj7. Fewer ideas, developed longer.

Module E - Motif Cycle and Density Ladder

Pass	Density	Rule
1	2 tones/bar	one motif fragment only
2	3 tones/bar	same contour
3	4 tones/bar	add one rhythmic variation
4	5 tones/bar	add one chord-tone target
5	back to 2 tones/bar	retain identity after reduction
6	one silent bar	re-enter motif from memory

The player must be able to reduce density without losing pulse or sounding as if the phrase simply stopped.

Module F - Style-Preserving Reharmonization

Base harmony	Reharmonized version	Keep constant
C-Am-F-G	C-A7-Dm-G7	reggae offbeat placement
C-Am-F-G	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	soul backbeat figure
A-D-E-A	A7-D9-E9-A7	funk ghost hierarchy
G-C-D-G	Gmaj7-Cmaj7-D7-Gmaj7	country boom-chuck engine
A7-D7-E7-A7	Am7-D9-E7-Am7	shuffle spacing
Dm7-G7-Cmaj7	Dm9-G13-Cmaj9	jazz swing placement

If the groove identity disappears after reharmonization, simplify the voicing. Chord color is subordinate to pocket.

Module G - Rapid Style Switch Drills

Switch	Bars	Requirement
straight rock -> shuffle	2 + 2	same tempo, subdivision feel changes
reggae -> ska	2 + 2	same offbeat placement, density increases
funk -> soul	2 + 2	ghost grid reduces to backbeat shells
country -> disco	2 + 2	bass/chord role changes to upper pulse
jazz swing -> shuffle	2 + 2	same triplet grid, density changes
Afrobeat-style -> jam-band	2 + 2	repeated cell opens into space

No neutral reset bar. The last beat of the old style must prepare the physical motion required by the new style.

Module G - Tempo-Identity Test

Perform each groove at three tempos: slow, medium, and performance tempo. The stylistic identity must survive all three.

Groove	Slow-tempo danger	Fast-tempo danger
Swing	straightens	overcomping
Shuffle	loses bounce	rushes short note
Reggae	stabs too long	upstrokes tense
Funk	ghost hierarchy disappears	noise rises
Country	bass/chord disconnect	fills overrun
Jam-band	too much empty time feels insecure	constant noodling

Do not raise tempo until the slow version still sounds stylistically intentional.

Module H - Study 1 - Swing to shuffle

| Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | Cmaj7 | A7 | D7 | G7 | Cmaj7 |

Bars 1-4 sparse swing shells; 5-8 shuffle pulse. Triplet grid remains constant.

Pass	Requirement
1	clap subdivision/timeline only
2	muted strings
3	single voicing family
4	full style behavior
5	bass-space/ensemble-space decisions
6	record without stopping

Module H - Study 2 - Interlock study

| Am7 | D9 | Am7 | D9 | Cmaj7 | Fmaj7 | G7 | G7 |

Bars 1-4 Afrobeat-style repeated upper cell; 5-8 clave-aware sparse chord placement.

Pass	Requirement
1	clap subdivision/timeline only
2	muted strings
3	single voicing family
4	full style behavior
5	bass-space/ensemble-space decisions
6	record without stopping

Module H - Study 3 - Jam-band development

| A | D | A | E | A | D | E | A |

One motif across 8 bars; density 2 -> 3 -> 4 -> 2 notes/bar; bar 8 space before tonic.

Pass	Requirement
1	clap subdivision/timeline only
2	muted strings
3	single voicing family
4	full style behavior
5	bass-space/ensemble-space decisions
6	record without stopping

Module H - Study 4 - Multi-style harmonic constant

| C | Am | F | G | C | Am | F | G |

2 bars reggae, 2 soul, 2 disco, 2 jam-band without changing progression or tempo.

Pass	Requirement
1	clap subdivision/timeline only
2	muted strings
3	single voicing family
4	full style behavior
5	bass-space/ensemble-space decisions
6	record without stopping

Module I - Forty-Bar Section XII Groove Capstone

Bars	Harmony	Style engine	Primary behavior
1-4	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-Cmaj7	jazz swing	sparse shells
5-8	A7-D7-E7-A7	shuffle	repeated bounce
9-12	Am7-D9-Am7-D9	Afrobeat-style	upper repeated cell
13-16	Cmaj7-Fmaj7-G7-Cmaj7	clave-aware interlock	syncopated triads
17-20	A-D-A-E	jam-band pocket	motif + space
21-24	Am7-D9-G13-Cmaj9	funk/R&B recall	ghost hierarchy
25-28	C-F-G-C	reggae/ska recall	offbeat density switch
29-32	G-C-D-G	country recall	alternating bass/chuck
33-36	E5-G5-A5-E5	rock recall	muted drive
37-40	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	synthesis/outro	style choice by cue

Use one master tempo for passes 1-4. In bars 37-40, a partner or random cue selects one previously studied style engine; harmony stays fixed.

Module J - Section XII Completion Audit

Category	0	1	2
Pulse/subdivision	lost	recovers	stable
Note length/muting	uncontrolled	functional	precise
Bass/drum interlock	collides	some space	intentional
Style identity	unclear	recognizable	immediate
Repeated-figure discipline	constantly varies	mostly stable	controlled
Register/texture	flat	some contrast	clear
Style switching	breaks tempo	functional	seamless
Recovery	restart	simplifies	seamless

Pass Section XII: 14/16 or better on two separate days, with no zero in pulse/subdivision, bass/drum interlock, style switching, or recovery.

Section XII is now complete. Level 91 begins Section XIII: Advanced Expression & Articulation - bend intonation, oblique/unison bends, vibrato architecture, rakes, grace notes, harmonics, dynamic picking, and expressive timing.

Fixed roadmap: Levels 91-94 Advanced Expression; 95-99 Repertoire Integration; 100-104 Composition; Level 105 Final Musicianship Capstone. HARD STOP after Level 105.